Who should I vote for?

Using AI to turn a voice note into a voting recommendation for Israel's 26th Knesset election, 27 October 2026

On the eve of the election I recorded 42 minutes on what I think is broken in Israeli politics and what I care about as a voter. Claude turned that into a scoring rubric. Research agents gathered evidence on every list on the ballot, and each list was scored against my priorities. This document follows the whole run, from the voice note to the recommendation.

BEST MATCHES, ABOVE THE THRESHOLD

1	2	3
רק	**אמת**	**ל**
Together (B'Yachad)	**The Democrats**	**Yisrael Beiteinu**
score 71.5	score 63.5	score 54

Daniel Rosehill · Jerusalem
Election to the 26th Knesset, 27 October 2026

Prepared with Claude Opus 5.5 (Anthropic)
github.com/danielrosehill/Israel-Election-2026-Vote-Decision

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AT A GLANCE

The result

On the rubric built from my voice note, these are the three best matches among lists polling above the electoral threshold. They keep the same order whether everyday issues count for 70%, 50% or 100% of the score.

CHOICE 1

רק

Together (B'Yachad)

Naftali Bennett

71.5 out of 100

everyday 70 · national 75

CHOICE 2

אמת

The Democrats

Yair Golan

63.5 out of 100

everyday 51 · national 92.5

CHOICE 3

ל

Yisrael Beiteinu

Avigdor Lieberman

54 out of 100

everyday 45 · national 75

Hebrew letters are the ballot-slip letters from the Central Elections Committee candidate lists (my Hugging Face dataset). Check them against the slips in the booth.

⚠ The headline finding is a gap

No list on the ballot has a real tenant-protection policy, which is my top issue. The best score on it is **3 out of 5** (Together, for tax incentives on leases of five years or more). Nobody proposes limits on no-cause or retaliatory eviction, or enforcement of repair duties or of the agent-fee ban. In the note I said "not a single major party … had bothered to articulate any serious policy for" it (07:25), and that is still true on election day.

The top five, and why

1 **רק** — **Together (B'Yachad)** · Naftali Bennett · polled 11.9 seats

The strongest everyday offer: the most detailed cost-of-living plan (import and tariff liberalisation with price targets), 100,000 long-term rental units, and the only measure aimed at lease length. Weaker than the Democrats on national issues (Bennett's annexation stance), and its identity is partly "replace Netanyahu".

71.5

2 **אמת** — **The Democrats** · Yair Golan · polled 9 seats

The closest match on almost every national issue, the best-documented programme (a 16-page platform PDF), and the only real plan on Israel's reputation. On rent it diagnoses the problem but offers only more public and long-term rental. On prices it leans on controls rather than competition.

63.5

3 **ל** — **Yisrael Beiteinu** · Avigdor Lieberman · polled 7.2 seats

Concrete rental-supply and mortgage numbers, and strong on competition (ending exclusive importers) and on religion and state. Nothing on tenant protection, services or reputation, and it leads with the Haredi draft, the "same story" framing.

54

4 **ודם** — **Joint List** · Yousef Jabareen · polled 8.1 seats

The only rent cap of any major list (20% of household income) and a published socio-economic programme in Hebrew and Arabic. Its trade protectionism and its security positions are far from mine.

46.8

5 דרך

Yashar · Gadi Eisenkot · polled 21.4 seats

Polls second overall and fits me on national issues, but on everyday issues it offers one undetailed phrase on renters. It leads with the October 7 commission and its leader's name: the ex-general's-party pattern from the note.

46.5

Excluded by my own rule

Netanyahu is "the one person I'm for sure not voting for" (06:48). Lists running him for PM, or pledged to recommend only him, are scored but never recommended: Amcha Yisrael, Religious Zionist Party – Zehut, Likud, Shas, Otzma Yehudit, Noam. The best match below the threshold is The Reservists and the Economic Party (about 2.1 seats in recent polls).

THE PROCESS, END TO END

How it was done

The whole run happened on election day, 27 October 2026. It went from a voice note recorded the evening before to a recommendation, through six stages. Each stage's output is in the repository, so every step can be checked.

STAGE 1 Voice note

Daniel · 26 October 2026

A 42-minute note on what I think is broken in Israeli politics and what I care about as a voter. It ends with the research task.

Output: `context/voice-notes/2026-10-26-politics/`

STAGE 2 Transcription and audio tidy

AssemblyAI universal model · Claude Opus 5.5

Raw transcript kept unedited, plus a disfluency-free version (Appendix A) and a lightly edited one. The audio was tidied from the word timestamps: 313 filler and stutter words and every pause over 0.7 s cut, taking it from 42:28 to 35:15.

Output: `transcript-*.md, voice-note-tidied.mp3`

STAGE 3 Rubric and weights

Claude Opus 5.5 · 27 October 2026

My positions extracted from the note, each cited to its timestamp, turned into 15 criteria in two streams. The weights were assigned by Claude from the note's emphasis.

Output: `docs/rubric.md`

STAGE 4 Research

Four Claude Sonnet agents, in parallel

Sourced evidence on all 38 filed lists, from party platforms and sites, the Israel Democracy Institute and the press, each claim marked confirmed or inferred. One thin pass (the right bloc) was sent back for a deeper second pass.

Output: `research/parties/`

STAGE 5 Scoring

One Claude Opus agent, single pass

Every list scored 0–5 on all 15 criteria from that evidence, with a written reason for each score, so all lists are graded against the same reading of the rubric.

Output: `data/scores.json`

STAGE 6 Ranking and report

scripts/rank.py · Typst

Stream scores combined, my exclusion rule applied, the result checked against the polls, and the result typeset as this document.

Output: `data/rankings.json, output/*.pdf`

Attribution

Role	Who / what
Voice note, priorities, final decision	Daniel Rosehill
Rubric, criteria and **weighting assignment**	Claude Opus 5.5 (`claude-opus-5-5`), Anthropic, 27 October 2026, from the voice note
Party research	Claude Sonnet agents, 27 October 2026, brief in `research/BRIEF.md`
Scoring	Claude Opus 5.5, one pass, 27 October 2026
Transcription	AssemblyAI universal model (transcript id `c2ba33df-42da-45d1-8946-c62f9a74e51b`)
Data	Candidate lists and polls from my Hugging Face datasets `Israel-Election-2026-Candidate-Lists` and `Israel-Election-2026-Polls`
Typesetting	Typst, IBM Plex Sans, Alef (Hebrew), Lucide icons

STAGE 1 · THE VOICE NOTE

What I said

I recorded the note on 26 October 2026, looking out at the Knesset building. The full transcript, with only the disfluencies removed, is **Appendix A**. These are the lines the rubric was built on (times refer to the original recording).

“There's one rotten root to it, which is that in the way this country is set up, our electoral system, there is no accountability baked into the system.”

03:26
A6 accountability

“Hopefully Netanyahu will not be elected. That's the one person I'm for sure not voting for.”

06:48
B3 Netanyahu

“The biggest issue in my life, and it's not even close, is an issue that last time I checked, not a single major party running in this election had bothered to articulate any serious policy for. And that is tenant protection law.”

07:25
A1 tenant protection

“The cost of living and the rest of it is such that getting on the property ladder is near impossible.”

15:03
A2 housing

“Do I think that the Haredim, the ultra-religious, should serve in the army? Yes. I think the social contract can't exist like this.”

19:33
B1 Haredi enlistment

“The cost of living. No one seems to be doing anything about it … Everything here is overpriced.”

22:22
A3 cost of living

“I think the best answer to antisemitism and anti-Israelism is to make Israel great.”

34:56
A5 reputation · B9

“This is our programme. It's free, it's consultative, it's democratic. We welcome participation. We're here to serve you.”

41:25
the party I'm looking for

STAGE 3 · CRITERIA AND WEIGHTS

What I care about: the rubric

Who set the weights

The criteria and weights were assigned by **Claude Opus 5.5** on 27 October 2026, from the emphasis in my voice note. They are an inference, not something I dictated. The interactive version lets you change them.

The rubric has two streams. **Stream A** covers the everyday pain points I put first. **Stream B** covers the divisive national issues, which I set "to one side" for the first ranking but did not ignore.

Stream A · everyday pain points (weights out of 100)

	Criterion	My position	Weight
🏠	**A1** Tenant protection and rental reform	My biggest issue, "not even close". Retaliatory termination, tenancy at will, the unenforced three-day repair rule, illegal agent fees.	30
🏙	**A2** Housing affordability for residents	The property ladder is "near impossible"; luxury and investment towers instead of homes for residents.	20
🛒	**A3** Cost of living and competition	Everything costs double or triple; an anti-competitive market; the personal-import limit was a petty own goal.	20
🏛	**A4** Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	Utilities and Arnona admin, small-business bureaucracy, urgent care that left our son unattended, shelters closed or charging for parking.	15
🌍	**A5** Israel's global reputation	International anger is "largely justified"; hasbara is not the answer.	10
📊	**A6** Programme quality and accountability (meta)	A published, coherent, consultative programme; transparency; accountability, ideally constituency representation.	5

Stream B · national issues (each 0–5 for alignment with me, equal weights)

Issue	My position
B1 Haredi enlistment	Yes, the Haredim should serve; no benefits without contribution. But leading with it is "the same story".
B2 Judicial overhaul	The overhaul is "very, very dangerous, very erosive".
B3 Netanyahu	Not voting for Netanyahu: the exclusion rule.
B4 Far right in government	Ben-Gvir and Smotrich are extremists the system relies on.
B5 Palestinian question	Don't rule out a Palestinian state in principle; don't see a path to one.
B6 Security and alliances	A strong Israel that forms alliances where possible.
B7 Religion and state	Against religious coercion, especially in Jerusalem.
B8 October 7 accountability	A state commission should exist, but it isn't front-line policy.
B9 Diaspora and hasbara spending	Israel shouldn't appoint itself guardian of world Jewry or fund public diplomacy that "never really shows fruit".

How the scores combine

Stream A

Σ weight × score/5, out of 100. No evidence counts as 0: a policy I can't find is no policy.

Stream B

Mean alignment × 20, out of 100. No-evidence items are left out; at least 4 must be scored.

Combined

0.7 × A + 0.3 × B (also run at 50/50). Only lists polling at least 4 seats (3.25%) are recommended.

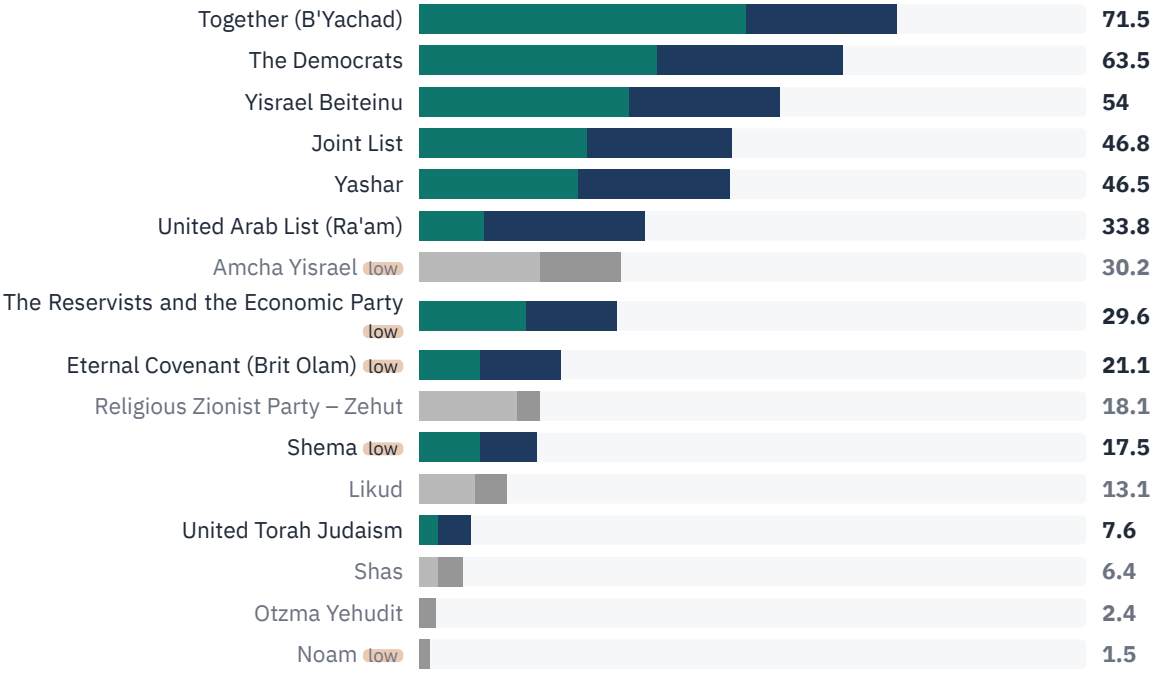
STAGES 4–6 · RESEARCH, SCORES, RANKING

The analysis

All 37 lists on the ballot were scored (38 filed; Blue and White withdrew on 19 October). The charts below show where the score comes from, how the two streams pull against each other, and every individual score.

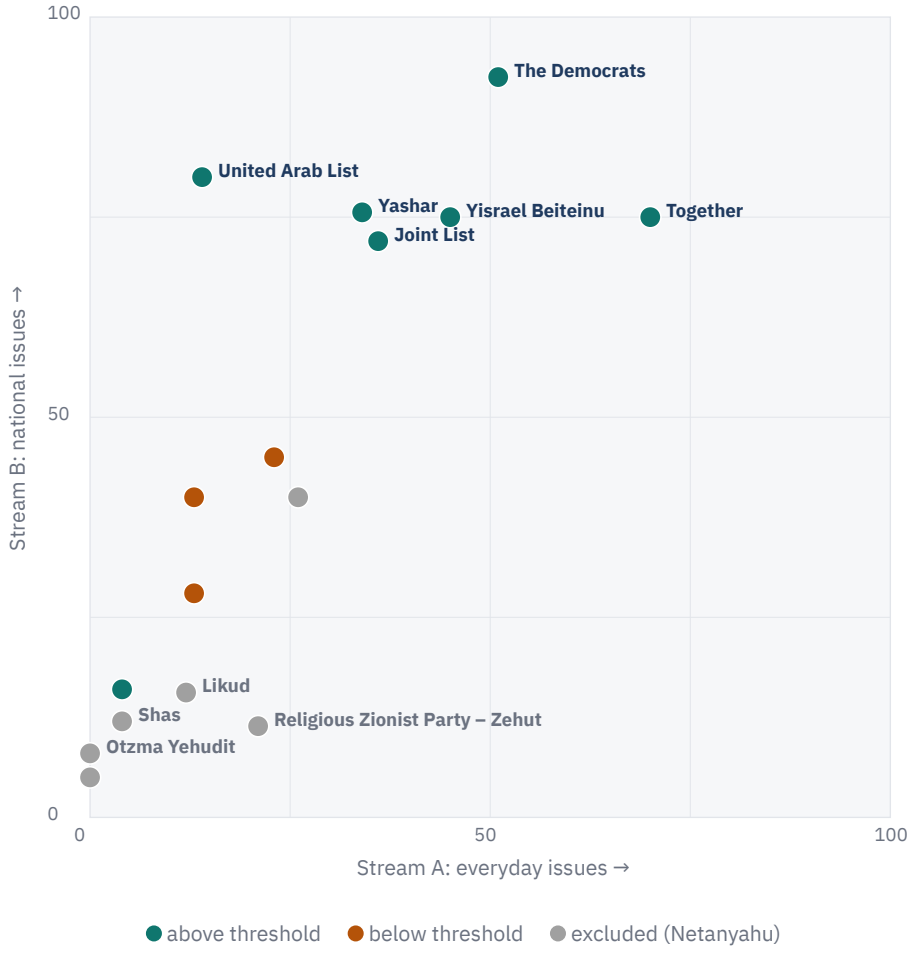
Combined score: what each stream contributes

Each bar is 0.7 × Stream A (teal) plus 0.3 × Stream B (navy). Grey = excluded under my Netanyahu rule. below threshold = polling under 4 seats. Lists with too little Stream B evidence for a combined score are left off this chart.



Everyday issues vs national issues

Stream A (x) against Stream B (y), for every list with both scores. Top right is the best fit on both.



Every score, every list

0–5 per criterion, sorted by Stream A. – = no evidence found (counts as 0 in Stream A, left out of Stream B). Criteria: **A1** Tenant protection and rental reform; **A2** Housing affordability for residents; **A3** Cost of living and competition; **A4** Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness; **A5** Israel's global reputation; **A6** Programme quality and accountability (meta); **B1** Haredi enlistment; **B2** Judicial overhaul; **B3** Netanyahu; **B4** Far right in government; **B5** Palestinian question; **B6** Security and alliances; **B7** Religion and state; **B8** October 7 accountability; **B9** Diaspora and hasbara spending.

List	A1	A2	A3	A4	A5	A6	B1	B2	B3	B4	B5	B6	B7	B8	B9	A	B
Together (B'Yachad)	3	4	5	3	2	3	5	3	5	4	2	4	4	3	–	70	75
The Democrats	1	3	3	3	4	4	5	5	5	5	4	4	5	4	–	51	92.5
Yisrael Beiteinu	2	3	4	1	–	2	4	4	4	3	3	3	5	4	–	45	75
Joint List	2	3	1	2	–	2	–	4	5	5	3	1	–	–	–	36	72
Yashar	1	1	3	2	2	2	5	4	5	4	3	5	3	3	2	34	75.6
Amcha Yisrael	–	1	3	2	1	2	3	2	1	1	1	2	3	4	1	26	40
The Reservists and the Economic Party	–	1	3	2	–	1	4	2	2	1	1	3	2	3	–	23	45
Religious Zionist Party – Zehut	0	1	3	1	0	2	2	0	1	0	0	1	0	–	–	21	11.4
United Arab List (Ra'am)	–	2	–	2	–	0	–	4	5	5	2	–	–	–	–	14	80
Eternal Covenant (Brit Olam)	–	–	2	1	–	2	–	2	–	–	1	–	1	4	2	13	40
Shema	–	2	1	–	–	1	4	1	–	–	2	–	0	–	0	13	28
Likud	0	1	1	1	0	1	1	0	0	0	1	3	1	1	0	12	15.6
Haredi Public	–	1	1	1	–	1	1	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	12	–
Israel First	–	–	1	1	–	1	4	–	–	–	–	–	3	–	–	8	–
Betach – Social Security	–	–	1	1	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	8	–
Pirate Party	–	–	–	1	–	3	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	6	–
Dawn's Light (Orot HaShahar)	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	0	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	5	–
United Torah Judaism	0	0	1	–	–	0	0	1	2	1	–	–	0	–	–	4	16
Shas	–	–	1	–	–	0	0	1	1	1	–	–	0	–	–	4	12
Together We Will Succeed (Beyachad Natzliach)	–	–	–	–	2	–	–	–	–	–	4	–	–	–	–	4	–
Garden of Eden (Paradise)	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	–
Fixing the Electoral and Governing System (HaTikun)	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	–
New Order	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	–
Hakahal	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	1	–
Otzma Yehudit	–	–	–	–	0	0	–	0	1	0	0	1	–	–	–	0	8
Noam	–	–	–	–	–	0	–	0	1	0	–	–	0	–	–	0	5
Tzomet – Beit Yisrael	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
Partnership for Everyone (Ihud Bnei HaBrit)	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
The Bible Bloc	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
Personal Security (Democtatorship)	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
The Color Black – Guarding the World of Torah	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
You and I (Ani VeAta)	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
Ahi Movement	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
Sharshar for Love and Unity of the People	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
Tkuma (Derech Hazon VeTkuma)	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
Women's Voice	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
Just Law (Mishpat Tzedek)	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–

Full ranking

#	List	Ballot	A	B	70/30	50/50	Seats
1	Together (B'Yachad)	רק	70	75	71.5	72.5	11.9
2	The Democrats	אמת	51	92.5	63.5	71.8	9
3	Yisrael Beiteinu	ל	45	75	54	60	7.2
4	Joint List	ודם	36	72	46.8	54	8.1
5	Yashar	דרך	34	75.6	46.5	54.8	21.4
6	United Arab List (Ra'am)	עם	14	80	33.8	47	5.5
7	Amcha Yisrael excluded	ך	26	40	30.2	33	1.3
8	The Reservists and the Economic Party	די	23	45	29.6	34	2.1
9	Eternal Covenant (Brit Olam)	זץ	13	40	21.1	26.5	–
10	Religious Zionist Party – Zehut excluded	ט	21	11.4	18.1	16.2	6.5
11	Shema	נף	13	28	17.5	20.5	–
12	Likud excluded	מחל	12	15.6	13.1	13.8	23.5
13	Haredi Public	זך	12	–	–	–	–
14	United Torah Judaism	ג	4	16	7.6	10	7.7
15	Shas excluded	שס	4	12	6.4	8	8.2
16	Israel First	י	8	–	–	–	–
17	Betach – Social Security	ז	8	–	–	–	–
18	Pirate Party	צף	6	–	–	–	–
19	Dawn's Light (Orot HaShahar)	בקר	5	–	–	–	–
20	Together We Will Succeed (Beyachad Natzliach)	בד	4	–	–	–	–
21	Otzma Yehudit excluded	ב	0	8	2.4	4	8
22	Noam excluded	ני	0	5	1.5	2.5	–
23	Garden of Eden (Paradise)	ה	1	–	–	–	–
24	Fixing the Electoral and Governing System (HaTikun)	נקי	1	–	–	–	–
25	New Order	קך	1	–	–	–	–
26	Hakahal	רץ	1	–	–	–	–
27	Tzomet – Beit Yisrael	בי	0	–	–	–	–
28	Partnership for Everyone (Ihud Bnei HaBrit)	ד	0	–	–	–	–
29	The Bible Bloc	יק	0	–	–	–	–
30	Personal Security (Democtatorship)	נץ	0	–	–	–	–
31	The Color Black – Guarding the World of Torah	נר	0	–	–	–	–
32	You and I (Ani VeAta)	פה	0	–	–	–	–
33	Ahi Movement	צבי	0	–	–	–	–
34	Sharshar for Love and Unity of the People	צדק	0	–	–	–	–
35	Tkuma (Derech Hazon VeTkuma)	ק	0	–	–	–	–
36	Women's Voice	קה	0	–	–	–	–
37	Just Law (Mishpat Tzedek)	קץ	0	–	–	–	–

Lists with fewer than 4 scored Stream B items have no combined score and are ordered by 0.7 × A. Seats: mean of polls released 10–22 October 2026.

THE EVIDENCE BEHIND THE SCORES

Party profiles

Lists polling above the threshold, plus the best matches below it, in order of combined score. Each score has the reason the scoring agent gave. *(inferred)* marks a score based on the list's record or alliances rather than a stated position. Full evidence with sources is in `research/parties/`.

רק Together (B'Yachad)

Naftali Bennett · polled 11.9 seats

71.5
A 70 · B 75

The strongest offer on Daniel's everyday issues: a detailed cost-of-living plan with import liberalisation, a large long-term rental programme and the only landlord incentive for longer leases. It still has nothing on retaliatory eviction, agent fees or enforcement, and Bennett's annexation stance and the 'replace Netanyahu' framing sit poorly with him.

A1	**Tenant protection and rental reform**	**3**	**Not supply-only: tax benefits for private landlords on 5+ year leases and 'long-term certainty for tenants', plus 100k long-term rental units (40% regulated, 30% below market). Nothing on eviction, retaliation, agent fees or enforcement. Lapid/German co-sponsored the 2017 Fair Rental Law**
A2	Housing affordability for residents	4	Concrete: 100k long-term rental units in 10 years, lease-purchase after 10 years, urban-renewal and permit timelines. Benefits skewed to reservists; no curbs on investment-only stock
A3	Cost of living and competition	5	Most specific A3 plan of any list: food prices -30% in 3 years, lower import barriers, gradual tariff cuts, break importer monopolies, accept international kosher certification, OECD-average basket target
A4	Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	3	Plan pages exist on health, transport, small businesses and public service, but the evidence file did not read them *(inferred)*
A5	Israel's global reputation	2	Ending regional isolation through alliances; no explicit plan to repair reputation through conduct
A6	Programme quality and accountability (meta)	3	About 25 web plan pages in Hebrew, English, Russian and Amharic, with some numeric targets; PM term limit and a constitution proposal. No PDF, not costed, no consultation; identity partly 'replace Netanyahu'
B1	Haredi enlistment	5	Mandatory conscription; no state funding for those who don't serve, work or study the core curriculum
B2	Judicial overhaul	3	Regulate Basic Laws and the judiciary 'through broad consensus', constitution proposal: not a pledge to repeal the overhaul
B3	Netanyahu	5	Replacing Netanyahu is the list's core purpose
B4	Far right in government	4	Anti-Netanyahu bloc; no explicit ruling-out of Ben-Gvir/Smotrich read *(inferred)*
B5	Palestinian question	2	Bennett favours annexing Area C and rejects statehood; Lapid's separation line is subordinate. Joint position unclear
B6	Security and alliances	4	Strong security plus regional alliances
B7	Religion and state	4	Bennett backs Shabbat public transport and civil marriage; religion-and-state plan page
B8	October 7 accountability	3	State commission as the government's first act: Daniel supports one but not as front-line policy
B9	Diaspora and hasbara spending	–	Diaspora/aliyah plan pages exist but were not read; no spending position

אמת The Democrats

Yair Golan · polled 9 seats

63.5
A 51 · B 92.5

The best match on documentation and on almost every Stream B position, with the only substantive plan on Israel's reputation. On rent, its top issue for Daniel, it diagnoses the problem but offers only more long-term rental and public housing, and it leans on price controls rather than competition.

A1	**Tenant protection and rental reform**	**1**	**Names 'rent that shatters dreams' but the only remedy is to expand long-term rental and affordable public housing: supply-only, no numbers. Meretz's Zandberg co-sponsored the 2017 Fair Rental Law**
A2	Housing affordability for residents	3	Dense planning near transport, urban renewal, varied unit sizes, expanded affordable public housing; resident-aimed but no numbers
A3	Cost of living and competition	3	Fight food, drug and energy cartels, cut transport fares and out-of-pocket costs; but widens price controls and says nothing on imports
A4	Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	3	Broad: health, welfare, education, public transport, north/south rehabilitation, digital access to justice, more judges. Thin on bureaucracy and civil defence
A5	Israel's global reputation	4	Says Israel is seen as extreme and isolated; proposes a regional initiative with the US and moderate Arab states, Saudi normalisation, IMEC: repair through policy
A6	Programme quality and accountability (meta)	4	Full 16-page platform PDF (Aug 2026), structured 'five steps per theme'; site in English, Arabic, Russian, Spanish, though the PDF is Hebrew-only. PM term limit, no indicted ministers. Not costed, no consultation
B1	Haredi enlistment	5	Absolute equality of burden, national service for all, stop funding Haredi education networks; not the lead message
B2	Judicial overhaul	5	Repeal all 'regime coup' laws including the judges' committee law
B3	Netanyahu	5	Blames Netanyahu governments; 'no indicted PM'; firmly in the opposition bloc *(inferred)*
B4	Far right in government	5	Campaigns against 'the most extreme and religious government in Israel's history'
B5	Palestinian question	4	Two states, halt annexation, PA role in Gaza: further than Daniel's 'can't see how', but he does not rule it out in principle
B6	Security and alliances	4	Strong military plus regional initiative, Iran isolation
B7	Religion and state	5	Civil marriage and divorce, end Rabbinate monopolies, Shabbat transport, fight religious coercion
B8	October 7 accountability	4	State commission, implement conclusions; not the lead item
B9	Diaspora and hasbara spending	–	Platform PDF silent on diaspora and hasbara

ל Yisrael Beiteinu

Avigdor Lieberman · polled 7.2 seats

54
A 45 · B 75

Strong on competition and religion-and-state, with concrete rental-supply and mortgage numbers. It has no tenant protection and nothing on services or reputation, and it leads with the Haredi draft, the framing Daniel calls 'the same story'.

A1	**Tenant protection and rental reform**	**2**	**Supply-side rental: 20k long-term rental units a year, rent-to-buy saving 30% of rent; Malinovsky bill for a renter tax credit. No lease or eviction protection**
A2	Housing affordability for residents	3	Land tenders on build quality not land price, 90% mortgages to 40 years for young couples, rent-to-own; partly service-linked
A3	Cost of living and competition	4	Break monopolies including food, end exclusive importers, deregulate; unfunded per press

A4	Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	1	Fewer ministers and a constitution; no service-delivery, health or civil-defence plan
A5	Israel's global reputation	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	Programme quality and accountability (meta)	2	Hebrew web platform with concrete items and overlapping older text, no PDF, not costed; constitution, two-term PM limit. Leader-defined party
B1	Haredi enlistment	4	Universal draft, evaders lose benefits; but it leads its campaign with the draft ('same story')
B2	Judicial overhaul	4	Opposes the override clause and 'French law'; proposes a constitutional court
B3	Netanyahu	4	Vocal Netanyahu critic; no explicit rule-out in the evidence
B4	Far right in government	3	No direct statement; opposes Haredi parties and Netanyahu coalitions *(inferred)*
B5	Palestinian question	3	Regional package deal; past population-swap plan
B6	Security and alliances	3	Security-first, bigger defence budget; little on alliances
B7	Religion and state	5	Full separation: civil marriage, Shabbat transport, core studies for funding
B8	October 7 accountability	4	Promises a state commission (one outlet)
B9	Diaspora and hasbara spending	–	No evidence found in the research file

דת1 Joint List

Yousef Jabareen · polled 8.1 seats

46.8
A 36 · B 72

Has a real published socio-economic programme with the only rent cap of any major list and ambitious public housing. Its trade protectionism runs against Daniel's cost-of-living view, its security position is far from his, and it says nothing on tenant rights beyond the cap.

A1	**Tenant protection and rental reform**	**2**	**Cap rent at 20% of household net income: a real rent-regulation measure, but nothing on lease security, eviction or agent fees, and no mechanism**
A2	Housing affordability for residents	3	Guaranteed public housing, interest-free first mortgages, state construction, land for young couples; sweeping and uncosted
A3	Cost of living and competition	1	Wage and VAT plan, but tariffs against imports: protectionist, against Daniel's anchor
A4	Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	2	Free education from 0, long-term care insurance, funded crime plan for Arab towns; nothing on bureaucracy
A5	Israel's global reputation	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	Programme quality and accountability (meta)	2	Published economic-social web programme in Hebrew and Arabic (English/ Russian nav); undated, uncosted, no security platform
B1	Haredi enlistment	–	No evidence found in the research file
B2	Judicial overhaul	4	No explicit statement; opposition bloc that fought the overhaul *(inferred)*
B3	Netanyahu	5	Supports only a government that replaces Netanyahu
B4	Far right in government	5	Campaigns against 'racism, supremacy'
B5	Palestinian question	3	End occupation and settlement funding; further than Daniel, who doubts a state can be done
B6	Security and alliances	1	Deep military cuts; no alliances policy: opposite of 'a strong Israel'
B7	Religion and state	–	No evidence found in the research file
B8	October 7 accountability	–	No evidence found in the research file
B9	Diaspora and hasbara spending	–	No evidence found in the research file

דרך Yashar

Gadi Eisenkot · polled 21.4 seats

46.5
A 34 · B 75.6

A credible anti-Netanyahu security list whose Stream B positions mostly fit Daniel. On his everyday issues it offers one undetailed phrase on renters, service-linked housing benefits and a generic cost-of-living pledge, and it leads with the October 7 commission and the PM candidate's name: the 'ex-general's party' pattern he describes.

A1	**Tenant protection and rental reform**	**1**	**Youth package mentions 'assistance and protection mechanisms for renters' with no detail; Folkman (2017 Fair Rental Law author) on the list is a candidate record, not policy**
A2	Housing affordability for residents	1	Only 'housing benefits' for those who serve and a long-range planning authority; no supply or resident-affordability plan
A3	Cost of living and competition	3	National plan against cost of living: break concentrations, competition, international standards; no targets, nothing on imports
A4	Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	2	Periphery health/transport investment, professional civil service; no bureaucracy or civil-defence plan
A5	Israel's global reputation	2	'Expand peace agreements' within a security strategy; no reputation-repair plan
A6	Programme quality and accountability (meta)	2	Short 10-point brochure PDF; site in Hebrew, English, Russian; PM term limit. Not costed, no consultation; leader's name in the list title
B1	Haredi enlistment	5	Haredi and Arab service, equal burden; universal national service as a coalition condition
B2	Judicial overhaul	4	Protect rule of law and judicial independence; no specific repeal pledge
B3	Netanyahu	5	Rules out serving under Netanyahu, even in rotation
B4	Far right in government	4	No direct statement; rules out a Netanyahu-led coalition *(inferred)*
B5	Palestinian question	3	Expand peace agreements, Jewish majority; no statehood position
B6	Security and alliances	5	Strengthen the IDF and expand peace agreements: Daniel's 'strong, alliances where possible'
B7	Religion and state	3	'Inclusive Judaism', local autonomy; courts Shas; no civil-marriage or Shabbat-transport pledge
B8	October 7 accountability	3	State commission is point 1 of 10, the front-line framing Daniel objects to
B9	Diaspora and hasbara spending	2	1 million aliyah goal and keeps the Grandchild Clause: diaspora-oriented, no hasbara stance

עם United Arab List (Ra'am)

Mansour Abbas · polled 5.5 seats

33.8
A 14 · B 80

A pragmatic delivery party for Arab society with no published programme and nothing on rent, cost of living or reputation. Its anti-Netanyahu, anti-Ben-Gvir stance fits Daniel, but there is little else to score.

A1	**Tenant protection and rental reform**	**–**	**No evidence found in the research file**
A2	Housing affordability for residents	2	Arab-sector housing record (10,000 units in the 2021 deal), opposes demolitions; no general plan
A3	Cost of living and competition	–	No evidence found in the research file
A4	Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	2	Arab-sector crime and infrastructure focus; record of a 20bn NIS infrastructure plan
A5	Israel's global reputation	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	Programme quality and accountability (meta)	0	No published programme in any language; leader-centred

B1	Haredi enlistment	–	No evidence found in the research file
B2	Judicial overhaul	4	No 2026 statement; inferred from its role in the 2021-22 change coalition and the opposition to the overhaul *(inferred)*
B3	Netanyahu	5	Rules out partnership with Netanyahu
B4	Far right in government	5	Campaigns against Ben-Gvir
B5	Palestinian question	2	Has accepted Israel's Jewish character but refuses to call Hamas a terror organisation; no statehood stance found *(inferred)*
B6	Security and alliances	–	No evidence found in the research file
B7	Religion and state	–	No evidence found in the research file
B8	October 7 accountability	–	No evidence found in the research file
B9	Diaspora and hasbara spending	–	No evidence found in the research file

יד The Reservists and the Economic Party

Yoaz Hendel · polled 2.1 seats

29.6
A 23 · B 45

Pro-competition economics with a reform cadence, but no rent or general housing policy, and its identity is reservist burden-sharing. It polls below the threshold.

A1	**Tenant protection and rental reform**	–	**No evidence found in the research file**
A2	Housing affordability for residents	1	Only perks for those who serve
A3	Cost of living and competition	3	Free economy, fight monopolies, business-barrier task force, three measurable reforms a year; imports not mentioned
A4	Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	2	Regulatory-barrier task force for businesses; nothing on services
A5	Israel's global reputation	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	Programme quality and accountability (meta)	1	Hebrew principles page only; PM term limit
B1	Haredi enlistment	4	Universal draft, non-servers lose benefits and even the vote: leads with it and goes beyond 'no benefits without contribution'
B2	Judicial overhaul	2	Partial reform: split the AG role, Basic Law: Legislation, 'broad agreement'
B3	Netanyahu	2	Netanyahu 'not his red line'; recommends whoever brings most Zionist seats
B4	Far right in government	1	'Zionist government' without Haredi or Arab parties implies the right bloc *(inferred)*
B5	Palestinian question	1	Opposes a state; 'voluntary migration directorate'
B6	Security and alliances	3	Offensive doctrine; regional cooperation against Iran
B7	Religion and state	2	No budget without service; religious service tracks
B8	October 7 accountability	3	Investigate all failures; sceptical of the state-commission label
B9	Diaspora and hasbara spending	–	No evidence found in the research file

עד Eternal Covenant (Brit Olam)

Ofer Pinhas Lifshitz · polled – seats

21.1
A 13 · B 40

Proposes constituency representation, which Daniel wants, but inside a messianic, annexationist programme with nothing on rent.

A1	**Tenant protection and rental reform**	–	**No evidence found in the research file**

A2	Housing affordability for residents	–	No evidence found in the research file
A3	Cost of living and competition	2	Remove VAT on services, committee on bank/insurance fees; favours local over foreign labour
A4	Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	1	Cut surplus government posts
A5	Israel's global reputation	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	Programme quality and accountability (meta)	2	Hebrew web platform with 12 regional constituencies and a directly elected president: constituency representation Daniel wants, in a messianic frame
B1	Haredi enlistment	–	No evidence found in the research file
B2	Judicial overhaul	2	Court reform through a constitution process
B3	Netanyahu	–	No evidence found in the research file
B4	Far right in government	–	No evidence found in the research file
B5	Palestinian question	1	Cancel Oslo, sovereignty over Judea, Samaria, Gaza
B6	Security and alliances	–	No evidence found in the research file
B7	Religion and state	1	Governance grounded in a religious covenant *(inferred)*
B8	October 7 accountability	4	Immediate state commission
B9	Diaspora and hasbara spending	2	Urges diaspora Jews to take Law of Return citizenship

ט Religious Zionist Party – Zehut

Bezalel Smotrich · polled 6.5 seats · excluded: Netanyahu rule

18.1
A 21 · B 11.4

Smotrich's list. It is the only one that tried to widen personal imports, which is Daniel's own AliExpress example, but it has no rent or housing plan, and its annexation and far-right positions are the opposite of his.

A1	**Tenant protection and rental reform**	**0**	**Nothing on rent; Zehut's approach is deregulation *(inferred)***
A2	Housing affordability for residents	1	Smotrich's Finance record: land tenders and price forecasts; admits housing was not addressed in three years; no resident plan
A3	Cost of living and competition	3	Smotrich twice raised the personal-import exemption (Daniel's AliExpress point) and promised open banking; Zehut would remove import barriers. Record otherwise weak
A4	Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	1	Welfare, health and mental-health PDFs exist but unread; no bureaucracy plan
A5	Israel's global reputation	0	Annexation of the West Bank, Gaza and south Lebanon: hostile to repair
A6	Programme quality and accountability (meta)	2	Topic-by-topic platform PDFs, mostly carried over from 2021-22, Hebrew only, silent on housing and cost of living
B1	Haredi enlistment	2	Smotrich declined to take a position; several MKs opposed the exemption bill
B2	Judicial overhaul	0	Rothman led the overhaul
B3	Netanyahu	1	Netanyahu coalition partner
B4	Far right in government	0	Smotrich is one of the two Daniel names
B5	Palestinian question	0	Nullify Oslo, annex, encourage emigration
B6	Security and alliances	1	War in the West Bank, annex to the Litani; no alliances
B7	Religion and state	0	Jewish identity and family-law platform; religious-nationalist *(inferred)*
B8	October 7 accountability	–	No evidence found in the research file
B9	Diaspora and hasbara spending	–	Diaspora/aliyah PDF exists but not read

נף Shema

Naftali Goldman · polled – seats

17.5
A 13 · B 28

A one-candidate religious-moral list with an interesting army-base housing idea, but it is coercive on religion.

A1	**Tenant protection and rental reform**	–	**No evidence found in the research file**
A2	Housing affordability for residents	2	Move army bases out of cities to free land for 'hundreds of thousands' of homes; subsidised for under-35 servers
A3	Cost of living and competition	1	Support for vulnerable groups; no competition policy
A4	Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	–	No evidence found in the research file
A5	Israel's global reputation	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	Programme quality and accountability (meta)	1	One-man list's web platform on a non-party domain
B1	Haredi enlistment	4	Universal conscription of Jewish men, no exemption
B2	Judicial overhaul	1	Limit the Supreme Court's power to strike laws
B3	Netanyahu	–	No evidence found in the research file
B4	Far right in government	–	No evidence found in the research file
B5	Palestinian question	2	Opposes two states
B6	Security and alliances	–	No evidence found in the research file
B7	Religion and state	0	Religiously coercive
B8	October 7 accountability	–	No evidence found in the research file
B9	Diaspora and hasbara spending	0	Diaspora minister 'with significant budget'

מחל Likud

Benjamin Netanyahu · polled 23.5 seats · excluded: Netanyahu rule

13.1
A 12 · B 15.6

Runs Netanyahu, the one candidate Daniel will not vote for, and offers no rent, housing or cost-of-living programme beyond generic principles and its own record. Excluded by his stated choice.

A1	**Tenant protection and rental reform**	0	**No tenant policy; held Housing since June 2025 with no tenant measure**
A2	Housing affordability for residents	1	Housing named under 'society and periphery' with no specifics; claims a 1.2% price fall
A3	Cost of living and competition	1	Electricity reform claimed; Likud MKs helped revoke the personal-import exemption raise (Daniel's AliExpress example)
A4	Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	1	Holds Health and Interior; Comptroller found no body managing Iran-war evacuation and a third of residents without shelter
A5	Israel's global reputation	0	Answer is a quadrupled hasbara budget: the PR approach Daniel rejects
A6	Programme quality and accountability (meta)	1	Six generic principles plus self-reported achievements on a multilingual site; leader-centred
B1	Haredi enlistment	1	Bismuth bill keeps full-time yeshiva exemptions
B2	Judicial overhaul	0	Passed the judicial selection laws
B3	Netanyahu	0	Netanyahu is the PM candidate
B4	Far right in government	0	Governed with Ben-Gvir and Smotrich and urged them to reunite
B5	Palestinian question	1	Settlement and sovereignty
B6	Security and alliances	3	Strong security record claimed; alliances stated, isolation in practice
B7	Religion and state	1	Concessions to Haredi parties on funding and the draft
B8	October 7 accountability	1	Blocks a state commission; backed a politically appointed one

B9	Diaspora and hasbara spending	0	$730m public diplomacy; Diaspora ministry

ג United Torah Judaism

Ya'akov Asher · polled 7.7 seats

7.6
A 4 · B 16

A sectoral list whose only stated demand is a draft-exemption law. Its housing ministry record is negative for Daniel and it has no platform.

A1	**Tenant protection and rental reform**	**0**	**Held Housing (Goldknopf, 2022-25) and produced no tenant legislation**
A2	Housing affordability for residents	0	Housing minister unsure there was a crisis; repurposed general-public projects for Haredim
A3	Cost of living and competition	1	Pushed a VAT cut to 17%; no competition policy
A4	Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	–	No evidence found in the research file
A5	Israel's global reputation	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	Programme quality and accountability (meta)	0	No platform found
B1	Haredi enlistment	0	Exemption for all full-time yeshiva students, no sanctions
B2	Judicial overhaul	1	In the coalition when the judicial selection law passed *(inferred)*
B3	Netanyahu	2	Says it belongs to no bloc; earlier backed Netanyahu
B4	Far right in government	1	Sat in government with Ben-Gvir and Smotrich *(inferred)*
B5	Palestinian question	–	No evidence found in the research file
B6	Security and alliances	–	No evidence found in the research file
B7	Religion and state	0	Funding and autonomy for yeshivas and schools
B8	October 7 accountability	–	No evidence found in the research file
B9	Diaspora and hasbara spending	–	No evidence found in the research file

שס Shas

Aryeh Deri · polled 8.2 seats · excluded: Netanyahu rule

6.4
A 4 · B 12

A sectoral party whose stated purpose is a draft-exemption law and institutional funding. No platform and nothing on rent or housing; only an arnona-discount record touches Daniel's issues.

A1	**Tenant protection and rental reform**	**–**	**No evidence found in the research file**
A2	Housing affordability for residents	–	No evidence found in the research file
A3	Cost of living and competition	1	Arnona-discount expansion under a Shas Interior minister (attribution inferred): relief, not competition *(inferred)*
A4	Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	–	Held Health and Interior; no service or urgent-care policy found
A5	Israel's global reputation	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	Programme quality and accountability (meta)	0	No platform found
B1	Haredi enlistment	0	Will not join a government without an exemption law
B2	Judicial overhaul	1	In the coalition that passed the judicial selection law *(inferred)*
B3	Netanyahu	1	Long-time Netanyahu partner; conditions are on the draft, not on him

B4	Far right in government	1	Sat with Ben-Gvir and Smotrich *(inferred)*
B5	Palestinian question	–	No evidence found in the research file
B6	Security and alliances	–	No evidence found in the research file
B7	Religion and state	0	Seeks Orthodox character and Haredi institution funding
B8	October 7 accountability	–	No evidence found in the research file
B9	Diaspora and hasbara spending	–	No evidence found in the research file

ב Otzma Yehudit

Itamar Ben-Gvir · polled 8 seats · excluded: Netanyahu rule

2.4
A 0 · B 8

Ben-Gvir's list, which Daniel names as extremist and racist. No platform and nothing on any Stream A issue.

A1	**Tenant protection and rental reform**	–	**No evidence found in the research file**
A2	Housing affordability for residents	–	No evidence found in the research file
A3	Cost of living and competition	–	No evidence found in the research file
A4	Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	–	Ben-Gvir ran National Security; no civil-defence or service plan found either way
A5	Israel's global reputation	0	Encouraging Palestinian emigration and the death penalty for terrorists would deepen the damage *(inferred)*
A6	Programme quality and accountability (meta)	0	No platform; leader-led, demands ministries
B1	Haredi enlistment	–	No evidence found in the research file
B2	Judicial overhaul	0	Fire the attorney general, radically weaken the judiciary
B3	Netanyahu	1	Netanyahu-bloc partner, though it runs separately
B4	Far right in government	0	Is the far right Daniel names
B5	Palestinian question	0	Encourage Palestinians to leave Gaza and the West Bank
B6	Security and alliances	1	Looser military constraints; no alliances
B7	Religion and state	–	No evidence found in the research file
B8	October 7 accountability	–	No evidence found in the research file
B9	Diaspora and hasbara spending	–	No evidence found in the research file

CAVEATS

Limits and how to read this

This is one voter's fit, not a rating of the parties

Every score measures alignment with the positions in my voice note. A party can be serious, competent and well run and still score low here because it is aiming at a different voter.

- **The weights are an inference.** Claude Opus 5.5 assigned them from the emphasis in a 42-minute monologue. The top three hold at 70/30, 50/50 and on Stream A alone, but other weightings can change the order lower down. The interactive version lets you test that.
- **Missing evidence scores as zero on everyday issues.** That is deliberate (a policy I can't find is no policy), but it punishes lists with poor websites as well as lists with no ideas.
- **The research was done in a day, by agents.** Several party sites refused automated access and some PDFs were image-only. The 22 minor lists got 2–5 searches each. The first pass on the right bloc was too thin and had to be redone.
- **One scorer.** A single agent scored every list for consistency. That makes the scores comparable, but no second reader checked them. Every score has a written reason, in the profiles and in `data/scores.json`.
- **Inferred items.** Some Stream B scores rest on a list's record or alliances rather than a stated position; these are marked *(inferred)*. Ra'am reached a combined score only because one such item was inferred.
- **Polls are a snapshot.** Viability uses the mean of polls released 10–22 October 2026, not the result.

Where everything is

What	Where in the repository
Tidied audio and all transcripts	`context/voice-notes/2026-10-26-politics/`
Rubric (human and machine)	`docs/rubric.md`, `docs/rubric.json`
Research brief and evidence per list	`research/BRIEF.md`, `research/parties/`
Scores with reasons; rankings	`data/scores.json`; `data/rankings.json` from `scripts/rank.py`
Interactive version	huggingface.co/spaces/danielrosehill/Israel-Election-2026-AI-Vote-Decision

TRANSCRIPT, DISFLUENCIES REMOVED

Appendix A · The voice note

My exact words and order from the 26 October 2026 recording, with only fillers, stutters and immediate repeats removed and known mishearings corrected. Times refer to the original 42-minute recording. The raw AssemblyAI transcript and a more heavily edited, sectioned version are in the repository.

00:00 Okay, so today is 26th October 2026, the day before the elections in Israel. And I, like many people in Israel, feel very disillusioned, disenfranchised with the entire political system. But I turn to you Claude, in order to create a guide tailored to my own voting what I'm looking for in a party, as it were. So I'll set out in this voice note which will be in a public repository. Which is intentional, in case you're asking.

00:39 So we'll do our usual process of sending this audio file for transcription, then getting a cleaned up version and please keep the audio file, the binary in the repo and just link to it in the readme in case anyone wants to actually hear the original for chain of custody. This is just if. No, can't think of any reason why.

00:58 But it's a demonstration, I guess, of a voice to research workflow that I do a lot in which I'll use a voice note to record a lengthy research brief and get all the details in and then I'll send Claude off to do his Claude like thing. And then usually I'll try, I'll pair that with some kind of an output skill which I typically tend to use Typst. I keep thinking I'm pronouncing it wrong.

01:26 The typesetting program, which is just fantastic tool. So I'll usually then round out the skill by saying, Claude, summarize your research in a PDF, bake it into a PDF, put it to my Google Drive, send it to me by email. And that's kind of the life cycle of a research repository. Sometimes once off, sometimes it's a recurrence space. So this one is just a public demo and sometimes I'll generate a podcast from it.

01:54 So this one, I might also create a podcast episode too, as sometimes I prefer to listen to what Claude finds, or both. They're complementary. Okay, so here is basically my feelings on the current state of affairs in Israel.

02:14 So my long standing critique of Israeli politics is. And I'm recording this actually looking at the Israeli Parliament building from outside of a window here. Not metaphorically speaking, literally. I can see it from where I'm recording this and when I look upon it, I feel this feeling of disgust that rises from an institution that has become so far divorced from any mandate of serving citizens, that it's unimaginable that this house is a farce, it's not representing the interests of the Israeli Electorate. It's a collection of self important people infighting, people abusing the name of the Knesset, the institution in ancient Israel and some of the manifestations of it, the 120 seats and it's a slight on the old institution.

03:14 It's a Knesset of, it's a [unclear: "sugbet"] Knesset, whatever you want to call it.

03:26 And in the litany of things that I feel is broken and wrong with Israeli politics, I feel it stems from one very fundamental. There's one rotten root to it which is that in the way this country is set up, our electoral system here there is no accountability baked into the system and we have an electorate that accepts this because this is the way things are here and Israelis are at once. Is my external critique as someone who moved here from Ireland at once very worldly and sometimes also peculiar. Peculiarly. I'm having a hard time with some words today in a peculiar way insular in the sense that this is their frame of reference and this is how politics are done here.

04:17 And my frame of reference, having grown up in Ireland, which has its own pros and cons about its political system, but at least one of the good things you can say about it is that because you have a politician you vote for at the national elections for an electoral area and there is theoretically someone you can complain to or contact to get representation and we have this completely broken political system here in which there is, because of the design of the political system, we have incentivized an extremely fractured and divisive political system that is characterized by repetitive breakaway alliances that are splitting votes and which are often less often created in order to create genuinely interesting ideological propositions and coherent platforms and more often because some person didn't get the slate that they thought that was becoming to them and therefore they decided I'm going to form a breakaway party or the party exists because one of its core principles is we will not be in government with this party. And the commonality here is that none of these expressions articulate anything about what this party is going to do for the electorate or the people. That's the fundamental problem as I see it, with Israeli politics. So I've been kind of reading naturally about who's running in this upcoming election and trying to even summon up the

motivation to do that because it's exhausting. What there's like three more political parties, four more, five more from the last time.

06:19 Why? Who? And the first question you'd ask about any of them is, well, what do they stand for that's going to actually benefit my life. And all you read about in the news has nothing to do with that. The political system that we have here in Israel creates because the Israeli electorate is itself so divided in this system.

06:48 The only way to. The way in which parties differentiate themselves is by differentiating upon the slice of the electorate that they pander to instead of collective issues. And the reason I feel so profoundly disillusioned about the political situation in Israel is that I could say, okay, well, hopefully Netanyahu will not be elected. That's the one person I'm for sure not voting for. When people say, well, what about Eisenkot, what about this party, that party?

07:25 I say, it's the same problem. That's what. That's where I will be even more pessimistic than some people here because I'll say, yeah, it's more of the same. Can't you see that there parties who are saying we will, we demand that the Haredim draft exemption will end the judicial reform and the issues that matter to me in my 10 years living in the state of Israel as an immigrant who moved here from Ireland, by the greatest detrimental thing or the biggest issue in my life, and it's not even close, is an issue that last time I checked, not a single major party running in this election had bothered to articulate any serious policy for. And that is tenant protection law.

08:21 I spent the majority of June, July, it's all a blur this summer, basically self moving an apartment. And we did that because our previous landlord, we had a leak, woke up one day to find that there was water dripping on my bed. And when I asked after two weeks, we told the landlord on the day when I said, so are you gonna fix it? He came the next day and then sent us this. It was very pleasant.

08:56 Of course I'm gonna get a fix. I'm gonna get right on it. And then followed up the next day with an extremely angry, I couldn't believe [unclear: "state the apart"] and basically retaliatory termination of the lease. And we had, our son is now 15 months old. The time was much younger.

09:16 We were sleeping as a family on the couch because our room, it got to the point where there was mold growing on the roof. I was sending the landlord video updates being like, for your sake, not mine, you probably want to get on this asap because your place is being ruined. I got. Literally did everything in my power to

09:40 make it happen. And it's something that the law says they have three days to do it. And of course, he just didn't do it, because what's the point of having a law if there is absolutely no consequence to it?

09:53 And if people. What's the point of having a law if people are. The lesson that. The chilling effect of my story that reverberates out through our friends and through my colleagues and the rest is that don't dare exercise even the minimal laws you.

10:10 The rights you have, because the landlord will just decide not to renew your lease. And because we have tenancy at will, he can say, yeah, I just decided not to. Even though this was a very clear example of a retaliatory lease, it made absolutely no difference. And we found this turned into a.

10:28 But this is the hot issue that gets me hot under the collar. We consulted with a lawyer, and he was very unpleasant. We couldn't fix. We asked to.

10:37 Even we were trying to explain to the man that we need. He's like, yeah, just okay, if you don't want to stay here, just leave. And we're like, okay, but you do realize that we need a roof over our heads. I don't know if that point was lost in translation there, Mr. Landlord.

10:56 So when we went to our lawyer, we kind of got the same reaction. And we're both like, my wife and I, okay, we're just going to tell you what finding a place to live in Jerusalem is like at the moment. It means you go for viewings after viewing, after viewing, you have to firstly pay an illegal agency. Because every single agent has cornered the market in basically a scam that frustrated the previous attempt at creating tenancy law.

11:26 It's an illegal thing that they found this ridiculous workaround for, and de facto you have to pay it. That's one month's rent plus VAT to the agent fee. So when you find a new place, if you find a new place, you're looking at your weekend spent trudging around with a young baby. Neither of us have family in Israel.

11:49 Going in, in the heat of the summer to see the depressing places. We even found that some of the listings, this was the kind of pinnacle of it.

12:00 They began new trends, started saying this image on listings you'd see, image was enhanced with artificial intelligence. So you're like, wait, okay, so this is an AI image of the place that you're posting. And the last move was astronomically expensive. You have to disconnect all the utilities from the landlord's name because the local municipality in Jerusalem, in all its infinite wisdom, with which it exerts itself digging up the city and making this place chaos, has not actually come up with any workable system for tenants to

pay their Arnona, the highest one in the country, in a way that doesn't incur a yearly obligation to them on a property they don't own. So you have to literally do unpaid admin work for the landlord to get yourself and also to get yourself off the hook for paying somebody else's municipal bill plus electricity, plus water, plus the rest of it.

13:02 Then in the next place, you've the pleasure of doing all of this again. So the last time we moved, similar story. This landlord was a lot nicer, but we lost the place after paying rent every single month on time. The rest of it, because he wanted to give his apartment away to his daughters. So I can't even describe the cumulative, the mental sense of

13:31 loss of stability. A deep, a profound sort of when you don't feel like you have a place and we're working, we're putting, we're saving. Where my wife's an architect, I work in tech, and we're looking at the spreadsheets and we're like, A, it doesn't really matter because the numbers just don't seem to check out that we can do this. And B, even if it did, even if we were doing everything in our power to get on the property ladder and the rest of it and living off beans and rice, I don't think we'd have anything to show for it because every time we do this, the last move was 10,000 shekels. The next move was 10,000 shekels time off work.

14:14 This one, I literally moved half our boxes ourselves. So if you're listening, if anyone ever listens to this or reads a transcript and you're hearing a man rant for 10 minutes about how I spent my summer trying to parent a toddler while moving boxes to do as much of the move as I could, because between all these expenses and deposits and agent fees, we literally, to ensure cash flow, had to have a cheap move. That's when I look around and say, how is the state? This is just, that's the biggest setback to

14:51 for me, the Jewish vision of every Jewish person moving to Israel and having a place to live here and prospering. I'm like, yeah, but we.

15:03 The cost of living and the rest of it is such that getting on their property ladder is near impossible.

15:12 I can't. If I had literally, if my hourly rate were multiplied by the amount of hours that I spent tearing up ethernet cables in a previous rental, but to put them back down in the next one, packing boxes, unpacking boxes, moving boxes, finding place for things, starting unboxing. To do that with a family, I would be. My bank account would be in a much better state than it was now. Put it like that.

15:42 So that's been. Mentally, spiritually, personally. The drain that is sucked so much of what's good about this country and turned it into frustration and anger and cynicism. It's that other things, honestly, not so much. I actually enjoy living here.

16:02 The people are great. I love the food. I adapt to the culture. The tech is amazing. There's so much that's good here.

16:12 The bad thing, religious extremism, I find in Jerusalem, I don't like that it's becoming coercive. I'm not a fan of Jerusalem, to put it mildly these days at least. Or I'm very. Let's say I'm less optimistic about the city than I ever have been or more pessimistic. But that issue as well is just.

16:35 It's like a case study in how to mismanage a city. What's happening at the moment, an endless creation. It's sheer greed. It's absolutely. It's catastrophic.

16:49 The city is basically just digging up left, right and center to create this enormous glut of high rises, turning a blind eye to the fact that half of them are just for investment properties or people who won't live here, while people actually living in the city are literally watching these out of place big skyscrapers going up that they won't be able to afford to live in. And no one's even bothering to [unclear: "post a road change"]. And we're like, this city is a joke. Seriously,

17:16 who's actually. You read about the cable car going to the old city. You're like, that was the front news today on the Times of Israel. And you're like, who's calling the shots in this place?

17:29 Because they do not have their heads screwed on. The city needs the poorest city in Israel, this place needs jobs, incentives for creating jobs. We don't need luxury housing, crazy investment properties. We need coherent, accessible, affordable housing. And you can't just plonk people in housing without creating at least some basic scaffolding for an economy here.

17:54 And you look at the resources the city puts into that and it's atrocious, it's minimal. I don't blame any VC or investor from not really being so hot on the Jerusalem pitch. A city best known these days for religious extremism and riots and. Yeah, no, I don't like anyway, so that, despite all that negativity, I think Jerusalem is the capital of the Jewish world and the city deserves so much better than this and should be such a more inclusive, affordable and accessible place in this. And I use all those adjectives together.

18:33 So the anger comes from my feeling that this is just a microcosm of what's gone wrong in this country, that something nice about it. The good things about the city, about Jerusalem, the slower pace of life

compared to Tel Aviv, the fact that people are a bit less maybe so stylish. I like that. I really like that. Actually, I'm not a very ostentatious person.

18:59 But when that gets, what's happening now, the stagnation of the long term residents in the city center and this artificial glut of construction for people who will parachute in here for a few weeks a year, don't speak Hebrew, don't want to interact with people, what kind of a recipe for coherence in a city, in a capital city is that? It's a disaster. So where was I? Where should I pick up this rant?

19:33 So when I look at the, what everyone's jockeying over, do I think that the Haredim, the ultra religious, should serve in the army? Yes.

19:46 I think the social contract can't exist like this. You can't have an internal state within a state. You have to have some basic commonality within the state that the rule of law is the rule of law and you don't get benefits if you don't contribute. So many people, I can say from our own experience as well, there's no. If you're a struggling young family working and being beaten down by agent fees and slumlords and all the stuff we can talk about from personal experience ad nauseam, there is essentially no help.

20:28 When the war with Iran broke out, I feel like the. I was kind of in disbelief. That was long. That was a long war. The one earlier this year was it five weeks.

20:41 And you wake up one day, a siren goes off at three in the morning or whatever time it started. And you're like, oh crap. What's going on? And then I'm kind of a prepper or have become a prepper. You're like, well, everything's planned, right?

20:57 The shelters are open and they're not. And at the time, in our old place, like many buildings, we did not have a public shelter. And it's a litany of, there's no map, there's no interactive map. When war broke out, they weren't open.

21:18 I contributed a router to a shelter that got stolen. We got a parking ticket after the last war. That was crazy. After the ceasefire, the shelter was a car park, literally.

21:30 City run shelter was the designated. Sorry, city run car park was a designated shelter, deep shelter. And ceasefire was announced and we were charged for I think an hour or two of parking, exit fee. And you're like, what? For sheltering an emergency?

21:52 Are you serious? So it's just things like this. I'm like, what has this state become? How did we go from this collectivist, idealistic poor, but wholesome society to this thing? Because this is not a.

22:08 These dynamics are just, they're bigger than any one thing. These are just the little things that I notice. But so okay, to be more coherent. What things affect me in my personal life day to day.

22:22 The cost of living. No one seems to be doing anything about it. The fact that they had this tax exemption for AliExpress. How petty can you be? Everything here is overpriced.

22:31 It's always been overpriced. The competition, it's anti competitive. And some guy, Bezalel Smotrich, the right wing guy, introduces, raises the limit and they put it back. You're like, what a miserable government. This is literally, come on.

22:46 That's how. AliExpress is the escape valve for the Israeli economy. I'm convinced. You realize everyone is buying. Go on to AliExpress listing in any listing and you're seeing Israeli flags.

23:02 You're like, wait, is this everyone buying everything from this? And you ask your friends and you're like, oh yeah, that's so, we're all doing this because everything here, it costs double or triple what it does abroad. And it's. And there's no warranty. Or when you try to get your warranty, there's no warranty service.

23:19 It's all this dysfunctionalism. When I go to the US or visit the US with my in laws, I appreciate that they have so many internal divisions and debates in the US but the biggest thing that's a breath of fresh air when I visit the US is the feeling that there is a basic level of dysfunction. There's a basic level of dysfunction here that just feels gratuitous. You're like, it does not need to be this way.

23:46 Life does. It's like you're trying to make life hard. It's like the delivery driver who gets irate. A bad example.

23:57 But whether it's the bureaucracy for small business, it just feels like when that layer is removed, you're like, oh, well, stuff, actually. Oh, this is pretty nice. Other things I noticed recently. So our son, we had to go to ER twice in the course of the last month. We had a pretty rough month.

24:17 Our son just started. His began well a couple of months ago. So I have asthma, and I have very vivid memories of having an asthma attack as a kid. So Ezra comes down with the cold. We come down with the cold.

24:30 We're all there, miserable in bed, and suddenly he's really, really having a hard time breathing, right? So we're like, oh, this is pretty scary. We bring him to the doctor. The doctor says, this is our health fund. Prescribes Ventolin nebulizer.

24:46 We're like, okay, great. So we get that, we do it. And in middle of the night, we're like, this is not working. He's getting worse. You can see his neck.

24:55 He's pulling his neck. We're like, okay, this is, I don't feel good just staying here. So we call our health fund Maccabi.

25:10 And basically, I can't remember the first time we went to Terem. I don't think they answered. So by the time we got to urgent care, there's no, the helpline says it's not emergency response.

25:30 And the second time, which was more recently, was just much, much. That was terrible. So we went there to this urgent care place, which I won't name, which. Same story, same pattern exactly. And they say, his oxygen is a bit low.

25:45 We need to give him oxygen. We go into the room and we're just left there 20, 30 minutes, he throws up, nobody comes. And we're trying to, there's no one working there. And my wife and I are like, what do we do? It's supposed to just wait here, like they've just told us.

26:05 And he was refusing oxygen, he wouldn't put it up to his face. So we went to the ER. They were great. And we met another family there who had the exact same situation. They were like, yeah, we just don't go there anymore.

26:21 So the healthcare system, the vaunted healthcare system, which I appreciate in large areas is good, that's a problem. So I read about judicial reform. I read about whether Netanyahu is suitable to stay in government because of the corruption allegations about a few cigars. And I say the first thing sometimes, this is, everyone says this, but there was a time, if I said this before, it wasn't with conviction. Now I can say with conviction.

26:52 I'm not a Netanyahu fan at all. I really believe he's, I think, whatever, I don't think it's constructive. And that's my issue with Israeli politics. You can just say it's become obsessed with the minutiae of his rule and these issues about the Haredim draft, the judicial reform.

27:19 Before we create 10 splinter parties and we debate these grand issues in a country without a constitution.

27:33 I just wonder every single time how is it that we have a political system whereby electoral cycle after electoral cycle, parties can basically stand up with essentially no platform, coherent platform policy, platform research backed platform targeting the burning issues, OECD math scores. There's a list of them. And instead we see it as, well, we're going to create a new party that's going to be anti Haredim. This one's going to be pro Haredim. This one's going to be a mixture.

28:07 And I think it's across the board.

28:18 The fact that it's accepted by the people who will vote for these parties and that there's so much fractionalism and self interest that they can't learn the lessons of what happened to the destruction of the left and see that in their rush to create new splinter parties, they're splitting the vote and harming the collective interest. But no one, including the voters. And the organizers say, the October 7th Commission of Inquiry fault finding bring. Okay, that was horrific. It was a tragedy.

28:49 It was horrible. Of course there should be a State commission of inquiry. But is that the most important? That's not a policy. That shouldn't be frontline policy.

29:01 We're for state commission of inquiry into October 7th. That's a security, two potentially I think useful reasons for that. One, security review, improve, learn lessons and improve. That's a task for the security bodies. Two, culpability.

29:18 So there has to be punishments. And if that can, if that doesn't exist, then there's a more fundamental issue. But an independent commission, I just don't understand what that is supposed to achieve or do for the benefit of this whole state and this whole country. It seems like a very strange reaction to this horrible attack that this is going to eclipse everything else because the Israel I see that's tearing itself asunder, that's dog eat dog where people, young people who move here, make aliyah to come to Israel can be kicked out of a apartment because there's a property boom and the landlord decides he wants to cash in and they're on the pavement and the state and say there's. That's just the way it is.

30:11 I feel like those are more important issues that, those fixes would be more widely beneficial than any. The results of any state inquiry into October 7th could be. So I find myself looking at the one party after the other, the old ones and the jaded pattern of ex generals and I just see, creating their own party, just see another iteration of the exact same problem. The root, the rotten root, the total lack of, the lack of a political system that views the electorate is there to represent people that big issues, policy related to security, questions of national identity need national consensus in a constitution and in the tradition of democracy I grew up in, a referendum. Those can be those big issues, of course important and they are of course going to delineate between parties.

31:17 But there is a complete and utter lack of focus on the bread and butter, to use that really trite analogy. And the Israel that I like personally is an Israel where hard working people can do well, can afford to have a good life here to vacation in Israel without it being four times the cost of a cheap getaway in Europe. And of course the national issues. Israel's reputation is in the gutter because we have a, whatever this rotten system of government is that requires a extremist racist like Ben-Gvir and Smotrich and the others to hold this together.

32:09 It's just, it's hard to articulate, which is why I'm probably gonna have to cut some audio here at this part of the note. But I hope this explains where I feel what I care about personally. What I want to see is an Israel that is strong, that forms alliances where possible.

32:32 The Palestinian question, I will just say that I don't rule out a Palestinian state as a principle. I just don't see any way that it can be done and any, I don't think that's what's holding everything back.

32:55 I think that Israel's reaction to October 7th has created enormous and I think honestly largely justified international rage and disgust and the government has done nothing to. All we do is just fund more hasbara. Let's fire some more propaganda. And the world is tired of it. And Netanyahu comes out with, after telling us that Iran's being contained like he did last summer, suddenly retweeting an image of a bomb over Tel Aviv.

33:25 So we're like what kind of integrity is that? What kind of leaders, how low have we sunk from the days of wholesome people like Ben Gurion that this is just what passes other people in the Likud actually see it for that or just kind of laugh and say well that's just electioneering but it's a dismal place to have sunk. So I want an Israel where the people who thoughtful people not doesn't have to be technocrats but committed people furthering their collective good, peace and prosperity and focusing on Israel for once. Everything seems to be externalized for some reason. That's what I've noticed where the world, the global reputation is tanking and we're focused on building bridges with the Jewish Diaspora.

34:24 My long term philosophy here, contrarian again is that should not be in scope. If Israel's fighting the view that the Jewish people and Israel are different things. And I agree there's a portion of world Jewry who aren't Zionist then if you say on the other hand, well we're appointing ourselves the global protector and represent and guardian of world Jews. You've just created that conflation so you can't then turn around and say you've. I think it's unfair frankly.

34:56 And I don't think in a country with the kind of health care that exists at least in parts here, we should be doing that. Israel was founded in 1948. If Jewish communities abroad aren't interested in moving here, I would say why should we maintain this apparatus for these other big tranches of public waste, the efforts to combat anti Semitism, the efforts for public diplomacy that never really show fruit and create this national obsession with how the world sees us that is kind of almost glaringly, I just don't think serves any good. I think the best answer to anti Semitism and anti Israelism is to make Israel great. And I don't believe that everything, you can't criticism, you can't create a world where everyone likes you.

36:05 And we've just see so many good things here and also so many challenges I think are we've got a full caseload of stuff to work on in this country and building up this country and making this country what it should be. And we've got basically a waste of time, political leadership, political class that's asleep at the wheel. I think the economy and country is driven by the talent and skill of everyone else, including the army for that matter. And I think the politicians are just what they are. And we need a radically reformed political system, radical improvement in transparency, programs for government that are coherent.

36:56 And the meta thing is a move away from issues of. Because there'll always be these issues for people to, for parties to argue about the political, the security situation, if that never changes. But that's all we view as whether we're coming from the left or the right, that that's what it's legitimate for a party to articulate policy about. Then we'll never get past security. And that's what's happening.

37:20 The cottage cheese protest, the housing protest. That's ancient history in comparative terms now why is there no movement since look at the numbers. Situation's not getting better and yet we're all up in arms about judicial reform. Very dangerous, very erosive. But at least can we be consistent with the stuff we actually, if it was in proportion to what it's actually going to affect people.

37:48 I think people be on the street for that didn't talk about wealth inequality, intergenerational wealth differences in Israel. That's a huge issue. And I think a lot of the disconnect from the political class and why they're so content arguing about anything but rent is that most of the political class in Israel belong to old families who have a lot of property and like many old Israeli families have an investment stream of that's being funded by newcomers and I just think it's such a perversion of the Zionist idealist. This was not how the idea of a Jewish state where every Jewish person had a home and it could have a dignified life here, this was not.

38:35 I can't imagine that this was anything like what Herzl intended. So that's who I. That's all I can get off my chest in these 40 minutes before the election. And what I look what I like from you Claude, is I am part writer, part data, part time data nerd. So I'd like to do this systematically.

38:58 You can take that lump of thought that I provided and give some coherence to it. And then I'd like to I've already created a data set for the parties on Hugging Face the lists, who's on the list and I'd like you to give me a. Let's do it like this. Let's define a objective rubric for judging the parties according to the issues that I assign priority to and where I stand on those. Then one by one let's review each party, let's give them a score and then let's stratify this analysis based upon alignment with what I would call my socioeconomic and non divisive, none, not, let's put security, nation states, Haredi enlistment, let's put those in to one side for the moment let's call that stream B issues and stream A issues are the less contentious things I see as the everyday pain points facing Israeli citizens and I've given just a few examples rent, housing instability, cost of living, bureaucracy and I would actually put in Israel's global reputation in that because on the one hand it's a meta issue, on the other it's one that trickles.

40:18 Everyone bears that in some way or another I believe.

40:26 Let's call those A and I'd like to firstly rank the parties from most best match to lowest match just on that axis and then on both axis so split 2 will be alignment together and then you can give me a analysis with the summary of the party's positions and I will say as one meta guide, one high level guide to what I'm looking for is really my [unclear: "David Fiducia"] party the mission we're here not because we demand a commission of inquiry for October 7th because we say the Haredim must serve that language, whether I agree with it or not, immediately alienates me because I say it's the same next version of the same story. The last 10 elections, 2026 edition. We're here because we can see that the state of Israel. We're here.

41:25 I didn't even mention Iran, but put security in [unclear: "In Tron, whatever it was. Tron"]. And this is our program. It's free, it's consultative, it's democratic.

41:36 We welcome participation. We're here to serve you. And this is how we think. This is how we propose to do it.

41:45 Cards on the table. Manifestations of that, literally, the bar is so incredibly low that you're like, well, if they had a PDF on their website for a certain area policy translated into all commonly spoken languages in Israel, even I think that would be a hard bar to pass. But that would be a very favorable indication.

42:08 That's it. That's today's research task. And maybe good, I recorded that so I can get my public journal about my thoughts on what's. What I'm finding frustrating about the political cycle in Israel and just where we are as a country at the moment. Onto this notepad.